A Spanish edition of *Magnifica Humanitas*

A brief for a writer. Written in English, with Spanish where Spanish is the point — the writer will read both; the person commissioning it does not read Spanish comfortably.

A note for whoever is reading this

If you are being asked for a recommendation: we are looking for someone to write the Spanish edition of a small publication on Pope Leo XIV's 2026 encyclical *Magnifica Humanitas*. The role is set out below. If a name comes to mind, we would be grateful — and if the person is you, so much the better.

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1. The publication

Magnifica Humanitas is a commentary publication on the encyclical of the same name: human dignity in the age of artificial intelligence. It is small, deliberate, and citation-driven — every claim about the document traces to the document.

The English edition is live at **https://magnifica.catholic.work**.

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2. What we are asking for

A **Spanish edition** — written in Spanish, not translated into it.

We are not looking for a translation service. A translation is a derivative of the English text, and however good it is, it reads as one. What we want is a Spanish edition that stands on its own: same sources, same arguments, written by someone for whom Spanish is the language of thought.

There is one Spanish page online today, the encyclical's own page:

https://magnifica.catholic.work/es/documents/magnifica-humanitas/

Its quotations are correct — they come from the Vatican's Spanish text. Its short editorial notes were written by us, and we are not native writers. That gap is the reason for this brief.

How to read the guidelines that follow

Two things worth saying, because they shape how the rest should be taken.

The first is that everything below concerns **our editorial decisions** — which Spanish edition we cite, how a scriptural reference is punctuated, how emphasis is marked inside a quotation. None of it is a remark on how you would naturally set about the work, and none of it is a matter of doctrine.

The second is that on anything touching the faith, **yours is the judgement that should carry.** You will know far better than we do how to write in communion with the Church and how to handle her documents, and that is part of why we are asking. If something here strikes you as wrong, we would far rather hear it than have you work around it.

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3. Two kinds of text, handled differently

The distinction that matters most.

	QUOTED FROM THE ENCYCLICAL	OUR OWN WRITING
what	sentences of *Magnifica Humanitas*	essays, introductions, notes, summaries
how	**looked up** in the official Spanish edition	**written** in Spanish
latitude	none	full, within the register below

Quotations are never translated

The Holy See has issued *Magnifica Humanitas* in Spanish as well as English. The Spanish edition is not a translation of the English edition — it is the same document in Spanish, with its own settled wording, and it is authoritative for Spanish.

So when our Spanish page quotes the encyclical, the quotation is taken from the official Spanish text at vatican.va, **character for character**. It is never machine-translated from our English, and never restated in other words inside quotation marks.

Translating a papal quotation and presenting it as a quotation would attribute to the Holy See wording it did not write — which is why, on this publication, a passage is looked up rather than rendered ourselves. We would ask the same of the Spanish edition.

Our own prose is written

Essays, introductions, notes and summaries are written in Spanish by the writer. This is where the work is, and this is why we are looking for a writer rather than a translator.

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4. The register

The Spanish edition should read to the Holy Father as his own. His episcopate was in the north of Peru — a missionary in Piura from 1985, Bishop of Chiclayo from 2015 to 2023 — and that is why we have taken the formal register of that region as the target. Not for effect: so that the text reads to him as his own, and to the faithful there as familiar.

Target: the formal preferences of northern Peru — Piura, Chulucanas, the Diocese of Chiclayo — **used in a general way.**

Two boundaries, and both matter:

- **Formal, not popular.** This is the vocabulary a Peruvian bishop would preach in, not the vocabulary of the street. A doctrinal publication is no place for regional slang.
- **Regional, not parochial.** A reader in Lima, in Mexico City, or in Madrid should find nothing foreign in it. The regionalism stops at vocabulary.

In practice:

- ***usted* throughout**, rather than *tú* or *vosotros*. Formal address is native register here, not stiffness.
- **First person plural (*nosotros*)** for the Church's own voice, as the official text does: «debemos recordar», «no podemos limitarnos».
- **Latin American vocabulary**, not Peninsular.

NOT (PENINSULAR)	USE
móvil	**celular**
ordenador	**computadora**
coche	**auto**, **carro**
zumo	**jugo**
vosotros	**ustedes**

The regionalism stops at vocabulary: no diminutives in doctrinal prose, no local idioms.

5. Terms the Holy See has already settled

Where the Holy See has settled how a term is rendered in Spanish, we use its rendering rather than inventing one of our own.

The glossary holds 27 terms, every one of them checked against the official Spanish text. A sample:

ENGLISH	SPANISH
human dignity	**dignidad humana**
the human person	**la persona humana**
artificial intelligence	**inteligencia artificial** (abbreviated **IA**)
the custody of the human person	**la custodia de la persona humana**
the social doctrine of the Church	**la Doctrina social de la Iglesia**
technology, as a human activity	**la técnica** — distinct from *la tecnología*
the Magisterium	**el Magisterio**
Pope Leo XIV	**el Papa León XIV** / **León XIV**

These renderings are fixed for the Spanish edition. It is a small discipline that keeps the pages reading as one publication rather than as a series of independent pieces — and it means that our words for the Church's concepts are the Church's own.

6. Citations follow the Spanish convention

The two conventions differ, and each language follows its own.

	ENGLISH	SPANISH
scripture	Mt 25:14-30	**Mt 25,14-30** — comma, not colon
a paragraph of the encyclical	MH 107	**MH, n. 107**

Magnifica Humanitas stays in Latin, in italics, untranslated. So does *Rerum novarum*.

7. Emphasis carries the argument

The official text italicises words that are load-bearing. From MH 118:

> En cambio, debemos recordar que el ser humano no florece *a pesar* del límite, sino a menudo *a través* del límite.

The italics on *a pesar* and *a través* **are the argument** — the reversal from "despite" to "through". The sentence still reads without them; it no longer says what the author said.

So emphasis is reproduced exactly as the Holy See set it, and not added where it was not there: italicising a quotation the Holy See did not italicise would emphasise on the Pope's behalf, which is the same error in reverse.

In the official Spanish text, emphasis falls in MH 4, MH 9, MH 89 and MH 118. That is the complete list.

8. How the work would run

To begin, you would need no account and no access to anything. We would send you:

- this brief and the full glossary;
- the English piece to be rendered;
- the official Spanish text of every passage quoted.

You would return a Spanish document. We handle publication — layout, metadata, and the code that renders emphasis and citations correctly.

There is no deadline pressure and no obligation. If it turns out not to be a good fit, we would much rather know early than late.

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9. What good looks like

What we look at before publishing. We set it out here so that nothing arrives as a surprise later.

☐ Every quotation matches the official Spanish edition **character for character**, emphasis included.
☐ Every quotation traces to the **Spanish** source, not to a translation of our English.
☐ No paraphrase inside quotation marks.
☐ Terminology follows the glossary.
☐ *usted* throughout, not *vosotros*.
☐ No Peninsular vocabulary.
☐ Citations use the Spanish convention.
☐ *Magnifica Humanitas* untranslated and in italics.
☐ **The piece reads end to end as Spanish** — not as English in Spanish words. This is the one no checklist catches, and it is the one that matters.

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10. Credit, and two practical matters

By-line. Every piece on the site carries a by-line, and the Spanish edition would carry its writer's. The work should be attributed to the person who wrote it — with a link to a parish, a school, an order or other work if that is useful. We would simply ask how the writer prefers to be named: full name, with a title, or with a religious name.

Copyright. We quote the encyclical only in short passages and link to the full text at vatican.va. We do not reproduce papal documents, and any Spanish edition would keep to the same rule.

If the writer is a priest or a religious. We mention this early rather than let it surface later, simply so that it is not an afterthought.

- A member of a religious institute requires the permission of his major superior to publish writings on religion or morals — **canon 832** of the Code of Canon Law.
- A diocesan priest is not bound in the same way, though submitting writings on religion and morals to the judgment of the local ordinary is *recommended* — **canon 827 §3**.

We are not canonists and would not presume to advise. The canons are linked here so that a priest can read them rather than take our word for it:

https://www.vatican.va/archive/cod-iuris-canonici/eng/documents/cic_lib3-cann822-833_en.html

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11. Next step

Write to us. If you would like to see the whole thing before deciding, we will send the full translation standard, the complete glossary, and a piece to work from. There is no commitment in looking at it.